ENGLISH COMMUNICATION TRAINER HANDBOOK

Practical templates, real-life dialogues, interview answers, workplace English, and classroom activities

Prepared for trainers and spoken-English learners

Personal life • Professional life • Job interviews • Customer service • Phone calls • Meetings • Difficult conversations

How to use this handbook: Read the situation, model the dialogue with a learner, practise both roles, replace the details with the learner's own life, and repeat without reading.

A simple teaching cycle: EXPLAIN → DEMONSTRATE → PRACTISE → FEEDBACK → REPEAT

1. A simple formula for confident communication

Teach students to communicate clearly rather than memorise complicated sentences. Most everyday exchanges follow this pattern:

OPEN politely → **MESSAGE** clearly → **CLOSE** appropriately

• **Opening:** Good morning. / Excuse me. / May I ask you something?

• **Message:** I need some information about the course. / Could you explain this point?

• **Closing:** Thank you for your help. / I appreciate your time.

Tone changes with context

Too direct	Polite alternative
Give me your pen.	Could I borrow your pen for a moment, please?
Send the file now.	Could you please send the file when you get a chance? I need it for the report.
I don't understand.	Could you please explain that point in a different way?
You are wrong.	I see your point, though I have a slightly different view.

2. Personal and everyday life: real-life dialogues

2.1 Catching up with a friend

Situation: You meet a friend after a few weeks.

A: Hey! It's been a while. How have you been?

B: I've been good, thanks. Work has been busy lately. How about you?

A: Pretty good. I've been trying to make more time for family.

B: That sounds nice. We should catch up properly sometime.

A: Absolutely. Are you free this Sunday?

Useful templates: How have you been? / I've been ___ lately. / Would you be free on ___?

Trainer tip: Ask learners to replace the details with a real update from their week.

2.2 Talking about a difficult day

Situation: A family member notices you seem tired.

A: You seem a little tired. Is everything okay?

B: It's been a long day, but I'll be fine. I just need a little rest.

A: Would you like me to help with anything?

B: That would be helpful. Could you please take care of dinner?

A: Of course. You can relax for a while.

Useful templates: I've had a ___ day. / I could use some help with ___. / Would you mind ___?

Trainer tip: Practise expressing needs calmly and asking follow-up questions.

2.3 Inviting someone and responding

Situation: You want to invite a neighbour or friend for tea.

A: Hi! Would you like to come over for tea tomorrow evening?

B: That sounds lovely. What time were you thinking?

A: Around 5:30, if that works for you.

B: Yes, that works. Thank you for inviting me.

A: You're very welcome. See you tomorrow!

Useful templates: Would you like to ___? / That sounds ___, but I'm afraid ___. / Would ___ work for you?

2.4 Politely declining an invitation

Situation: You already have plans.

A: Would you like to join us for dinner on Saturday?

B: Thank you for inviting me. I'd love to, but I already have plans that evening.

A: No problem. Perhaps another time.

B: Definitely. Are you free next weekend?

Useful templates: Thank you for inviting me. I'd love to, but ___. / Could we do it another day?

2.5 At a shop: asking about a product

Situation: You want to know the price, size, and return policy.

Customer: Excuse me, could you tell me how much this costs?

Shop assistant: It's ■1,200.

Customer: Do you have it in another size?

Shop assistant: Yes, we have medium and large.

Customer: Thank you. Could you also tell me your return policy?

Useful templates: How much does this cost? / Do you have this in ___? / Could you tell me whether ___?

2.6 At a restaurant or café

Situation: You need to order food and ask about ingredients.

Customer: Hello. Could I see the menu, please?

Server: Certainly. Here you are.

Customer: Does this dish contain peanuts? I have an allergy.

Server: Let me check with the kitchen before I confirm.

Customer: Thank you. I'd appreciate that.

Useful templates: Could I have ___, please? / Does this contain ___? / Could you check with the kitchen?

Trainer tip: Teach learners to state allergies clearly and wait for confirmation.

2.7 Asking for directions

Situation: You are in an unfamiliar area.

A: Excuse me, could you tell me how to get to the bus station?

B: Go straight ahead and turn left at the traffic light.

A: Is it within walking distance?

B: Yes, it's about a ten-minute walk.

A: Thank you for your help.

Useful templates: How do I get to ___? / Is it far from here? / Could you show me on the map?

2.8 Making an appointment

Situation: You call a clinic or service provider to book a time.

Caller: Hello, I'd like to book an appointment, please.

Receptionist: Certainly. What day would suit you?

Caller: Would Friday afternoon be available?

Receptionist: We have a slot at 3:30 p.m.

Caller: That works for me. Could you confirm the appointment details?

Useful templates: I'd like to book/reschedule/cancel ___. / Is ___ available? / Could you confirm ___?

2.9 Handling a misunderstanding with a friend

Situation: A message was misunderstood.

A: I think my message came across differently from what I intended.

B: I wasn't sure what you meant.

A: I'm sorry I wasn't clear. I meant that I couldn't come today, not that I didn't want to meet.

B: Thanks for explaining. I understand now.

A: I'm glad we cleared that up.

Useful templates: I may not have explained that clearly. / What I meant was ___. / Let's clear up the misunderstanding.

3. Professional life: workplace and customer situations

3.1 Introducing yourself to a new colleague

Situation: It's your first day at a new workplace.

A: Hi, I'm Neha from the operations team. It's nice to meet you.

B: Nice to meet you, Neha. I'm Arjun from finance.

A: How long have you been with the company?

B: I've been here for about two years. Let me know if you need help finding anything.

A: Thanks, I appreciate that.

Useful templates: I'm ___ from the ___ team. / How long have you been ___? / Please let me know if ___.

3.2 Asking a manager to clarify a task

Situation: You have received instructions but need one detail confirmed.

Employee: Could I clarify one point about the report?

Manager: Of course. Go ahead.

Employee: Should I include the figures from the previous quarter as well?

Manager: Yes, please include them and highlight the changes.

Employee: Understood. I'll include both and highlight the differences.

Useful templates: Just to confirm, should I ___? / Could you clarify what you mean by ___?

3.3 Giving a progress update

Situation: Your manager asks how a project is going.

Manager: Could you give me a quick update on the project?

Employee: The first two sections are complete. I'm checking the data in the final section now.

Manager: Are there any issues?

Employee: I'm waiting for one set of figures from another team. I've followed up and expect to receive them today.

Manager: Thanks for the update.

Useful templates: So far, I've completed ___. / I'm currently working on ___. / The main challenge is ___. / I expect to finish by ___.

3.4 Admitting a mistake professionally

Situation: You sent a document with an error.

Employee: I noticed an error in the document I sent earlier.

Manager: What happened?

Employee: I used an older figure by mistake. I've corrected it and checked the remaining figures.

Manager: Please send the revised version.

Employee: Certainly. I'm sorry for the oversight. I'll verify the version before sending it next time.

Useful templates: I noticed an error in ___. / I've corrected it by ___. / To prevent this happening again, I'll ___.

Trainer tip: Teach responsibility without making excuses or blaming others.

3.5 Disagreeing in a meeting

Situation: You have a different suggestion from a colleague.

Colleague: I think we should launch the campaign next week.

You: I understand the urgency. My concern is that we haven't finished testing.

Colleague: What do you suggest?

You: Could we complete testing first and launch early the following week? That would reduce the risk of errors.

Colleague: That sounds reasonable. Let's review the timeline.

Useful templates: I see your point. My concern is ___. / Another option could be ___. / Would it be possible to ___?

3.6 Responding to a dissatisfied customer

Situation: A customer says a delivery is late.

Customer: My order was supposed to arrive yesterday.

Representative: I'm sorry it hasn't arrived as expected. I understand how frustrating that can be.

Customer: Can you tell me where it is?

Representative: I'll check the tracking details now and explain the available options.

Customer: All right, thank you.

Representative: Thank you for your patience. I'll update you as soon as I confirm the details.

Useful templates: I'm sorry about ___. / Let me check that for you. / Here's what I can do ___.

Trainer tip: Do not promise a delivery time or refund unless you have verified it.

3.7 Requesting a deadline extension

Situation: A task is taking longer than expected.

Employee: I'd like to discuss the deadline for the presentation.

Manager: What's the situation?

Employee: The data review is taking longer than expected. Could I submit the final version by Thursday morning instead?

Manager: Please send me the completed sections today and the final version on Thursday.

Employee: That works. I'll send the completed sections by the end of today.

Useful templates: Due to ___, would it be possible to extend the deadline to ___? / I can send ___ by ___.

3.8 Asking for feedback

Situation: You have completed a presentation.

Employee: Could I ask for your feedback on my presentation?

Manager: Certainly. Your main points were clear.

Employee: Thank you. Is there anything I could improve for next time?

Manager: Try to shorten the introduction and add a summary slide.

Employee: That's helpful. I'll work on those points for my next presentation.

Useful templates: What did I do well? / What could I improve? / I'll apply that feedback by ___.

3.9 Networking at a professional event

Situation: You meet someone from another organisation.

A: Hello, I'm Kavita. I work in learning and development.

B: Nice to meet you. I'm Rahul, and I work in recruitment.

A: Interesting. What kind of roles do you usually recruit for?

B: Mostly technology and customer success roles. What does your work involve?

A: I design training sessions to help employees improve their communication skills.

Useful templates: What kind of work do you do? / What does your role involve? / It was a pleasure speaking with you.

3.10 Asking a colleague to help

Situation: You need support before a deadline.

A: Do you have a few minutes to help me review this document?

B: I can help after I finish this call. Is that okay?

A: Yes, absolutely. The main thing I need checked is the data table.

B: No problem. Send it to me and I'll take a look.

A: Thanks. I really appreciate your help.

Useful templates: Would you be able to help me with ___? / The main thing I need is ___. / Thanks, I appreciate it.

4. Telephone, video calls, and digital communication

4.1 Calling to ask about a job vacancy

Situation: You call an organisation after seeing a job advertisement.

Caller: Good morning. I'm calling to enquire about the English trainer vacancy I saw advertised.

Receptionist: Certainly. Have you submitted your application?

Caller: Yes, I submitted it yesterday. Could you please tell me whom I should contact about the next steps?

Receptionist: Please email the HR team using the address listed in the advertisement.

Caller: Thank you for your guidance.

Useful templates: I'm calling to enquire about ___. / Could you direct me to ___? / Could you confirm the next steps?

4.2 Joining an online meeting

Situation: You join a video call and your audio is not working.

Host: Welcome, everyone. Can you hear me?

Participant: I can hear you, but I think my microphone isn't working.

Host: Try selecting the correct microphone in your audio settings.

Participant: That seems to have fixed it. Can everyone hear me now?

Host: Yes, you're clear. Thanks.

Useful templates: I think my audio is muted. / Your voice is breaking up. / Could you share your screen? / I'll put that in the chat.

4.3 Following up by email after a call

Situation: You want to summarise what was agreed.

Person A: Thanks for speaking with me today.

Person B: You're welcome.

Person A: I'll send a short email summarising the tasks and deadlines we discussed.

Person B: That would be helpful.

Person A: Great. Please let me know if I've missed anything.

Useful templates: As discussed, I'll ___. / The agreed deadline is ___. / Please let me know if anything needs correcting.

5. Job interviews: templates and sample answers

Teach learners to structure answers around their own real qualifications, skills, and experiences. Templates are a starting point, not scripts to memorise word for word.

5.1 Tell me about yourself

Template: My background is in ___. I have experience/knowledge in ___. My key strengths are ___. I am interested in this role because ___.

Sample answer: My background is in commerce, and I have experience working with customers. My key strengths are communication, organisation, and problem-solving. I am interested in this role because I would like to contribute to customer satisfaction while developing my professional skills.

5.2 Why should we hire you?

Template: I believe I would be a good fit because ___. I can contribute by ___.

Sample answer: I believe I would be a good fit because I communicate clearly, learn quickly, and take responsibility for my work. I can contribute by supporting the team, responding professionally to customers, and completing tasks carefully.

5.3 What is your greatest strength?

Template: One of my key strengths is ___. For example, ___.

Sample answer: One of my key strengths is organisation. During a group project, I helped set milestones and coordinate tasks, which helped us complete the work on time.

5.4 What is one area you are improving?

Template: One area I am working to improve is ___. I am addressing it by ___.

Sample answer: I am working on becoming more confident when presenting to larger groups. I practise regularly, prepare clear notes, and ask for feedback after presentations.

5.5 Describe a challenge you handled (STAR)

Template: Situation: ___. Task: ___. Action: ___. Result: ___.

Sample answer: In a group assignment, we were running behind schedule. I helped clarify responsibilities, set short check-ins, and track the remaining work. We completed the assignment on time and learned to coordinate more effectively.

5.6 Why do you want this job?

Template: I am interested in this position because ___. My experience/skills in ___ would help me ___.

Sample answer: I am interested in this position because it combines customer interaction and problem-solving. My communication skills would help me understand customer needs and explain solutions clearly.

5.7 How do you handle pressure?

Template: When I have several deadlines, I ___. If priorities conflict, I ___.

Sample answer: I list tasks by urgency and importance, break large tasks into manageable steps, and communicate early if a deadline is at risk. If priorities conflict, I check with my manager rather than making assumptions.

5.8 Why are you leaving your current role?

Template: I appreciate what I have learned in my current role. I am now looking for ___ and an opportunity to ___.

Sample answer: I appreciate the experience I have gained in my current role. I am now looking for new challenges and an opportunity to develop my skills and take on greater responsibility.

5.9 What are your salary expectations?

Template: Based on the role and responsibilities, I am looking for ___. I am open to discussing the range budgeted for the position.

Sample answer: I am looking for a fair package that reflects the responsibilities of the role and my relevant experience. I am open to discussing the range budgeted for this position.

5.10 Do you have any questions for us?

Template: Could you tell me more about ___?

Sample answer: Could you tell me about the team's main priorities for the first three months and how success in this position is measured?

Self-introduction: a fill-in template

Good morning, and thank you for this opportunity. My name is [Name], and I am from [City]. I have completed [Qualification] and have [experience / relevant project or learning experience] in [Field]. My key strengths are [Strength 1], [Strength 2], and [Strength 3]. I am interested in this role because [Reason]. I look forward to contributing to the team and continuing to learn. Thank you.

6. Ready-to-adapt professional messages

6.1 Leave request

Subject: Leave Request for [Date]

Dear [Manager's Name],

I would like to request leave on [date] due to [brief reason]. I will ensure that my pending tasks are managed appropriately before my leave.

Thank you for your consideration.

Best regards,
[Name]

6.2 Interview follow-up

Subject: Follow-up on [Job Title] Interview

Dear [Name],

Thank you for the opportunity to interview for the [Job Title] position. I enjoyed learning more about the role and the organisation. I would appreciate any update you can share regarding the next steps.

Best regards,
[Name]

6.3 Reporting a delay

Hello [Name],

I wanted to let you know that [task/project] may take longer than expected because [brief reason]. I am working on it and expect to provide an update by [date/time]. I apologise for the inconvenience and will keep you informed.

Thank you,
[Name]

6.4 Requesting information on WhatsApp

Hello [Name], I hope you're doing well. Could you please share the details about [topic] when convenient? I would appreciate your help. Thank you.

6.5 Confirming a meeting

Hello [Name], just confirming our meeting on [date] at [time]. Please let me know if anything changes. Thank you.

7. Useful language bank

Purpose	Useful phrases
Ask for clarification	Could you explain that in another way? / Just to confirm, do you mean ___?
Give an opinion	In my view, ___ because ___. / From my perspective, ___.
Agree politely	I agree, especially because ___. / That's a good point.
Disagree respectfully	I understand your point. Another way to look at it is ___.
Ask for time	Let me think about that for a moment. / I'll check and get back to you.
Apologise	I'm sorry for the inconvenience. / Thank you for your patience.
End a conversation	It was nice speaking with you. / Thank you for your time.
Make a suggestion	Could we consider ___? / One option would be to ___.

8. Common errors and natural alternatives

Less natural / incorrect	Improved version
Myself Rahul.	My name is Rahul.
I am having five years experience.	I have five years of experience.
I didn't went there.	I didn't go there.
He don't know.	He doesn't know.
I am agree with you.	I agree with you.
Discuss about the issue.	Discuss the issue.
I will explain you.	I will explain it to you.
I am working here since 2020.	I have been working here since 2020.
Tell me your good name.	May I know your name, please?
Please revert back.	Please get back to me.

9. Student worksheets and role-play cards

Worksheet A: Complete the sentences

• I usually start my day by _____.

• When I need help, I usually _____.

• I would like to improve my English because _____.

• Could you please clarify _____?

• I would like to suggest _____ because _____.

• One professional strength I have is _____.

• A challenge I handled was _____.

• I am interested in this job because _____.

Worksheet B: Situation cards

Card 1 — Interview: One learner is the interviewer and one is the candidate. Ask about background, strengths, a challenge, and career goals.

Card 2 — Workplace delay: A task will be late. Explain the reason, apologise where appropriate, suggest a realistic new deadline, and confirm the next step.

Card 3 — Customer complaint: A customer has not received an order. Acknowledge the concern, check the facts, and explain what you can do next.

Card 4 — Social invitation: Invite a friend for a weekend activity. Discuss timing, location, preferences, and an alternative if needed.

Card 5 — Clarifying instructions: Ask a manager to clarify a task. Repeat the instruction in your own words to confirm you understood.

Card 6 — Meeting disagreement: Disagree with a colleague's idea politely. Acknowledge their view, explain your concern, and offer an alternative.

Card 7 — Phone call: Call a company to ask about a course or job opening. Introduce yourself, state the reason for calling, ask two questions, and close politely.

Card 8 — Asking for feedback: After a short presentation, ask for feedback, listen without interrupting, and explain what you will improve.

Worksheet C: One-minute speaking challenge

Choose one topic and speak for 60 seconds. Avoid reading a full script.

• Describe your daily routine.

• Talk about a person who has taught you something useful.

• Describe a time you solved a problem.

• Explain why communication skills matter at work.

• Talk about a goal you want to achieve this year.

• Describe a service experience that was helpful and explain why.

10. A 60-minute lesson plan for trainers

Time	Activity	Trainer's role
0–5 min	Warm-up	Ask three everyday questions; encourage complete sentences.
5–15 min	Teach templates	Introduce five useful sentence frames and model pronunciation.
15–25 min	Demonstration	Act out one dialogue with a learner; show natural tone and pacing.
25–40 min	Pair role-play	Assign situation cards and switch roles halfway through.
40–50 min	Interview practice	Ask two questions; encourage personalised examples.
50–57 min	Feedback and retry	Correct two or three high-impact errors and repeat the task.
57–60 min	Homework	Ask students to record a one-minute answer or practise a dialogue.

11. Simple student assessment rubric

Skill	1 — Needs practice	2 — Developing	3 — Confident
Clarity	Difficult to follow	Mostly clear	Clear and organised
Grammar	Errors often affect meaning	Some errors	Generally accurate
Vocabulary	Limited range	Suitable for familiar topics	Varied and relevant
Fluency	Frequent long pauses	Some hesitation	Natural flow
Tone	Often unsuitable	Usually appropriate	Polite and context-aware

Trainer reminder

Correct learners respectfully. Let them finish speaking before correcting them, focus on a few high-impact improvements, and give them another chance to say the sentence. Encourage natural, clear English rather than a memorised accent or complicated vocabulary.

Suggested teaching cycle: Explain → Demonstrate → Practise → Correct → Repeat.